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1907, Canal Colonies Disturbance

From an early age, Bhagat Singh was deeply affected by the plight of his two uncles. He had seen both Ajit Singh and Swaran Singh having to undergo long bouts of incarceration. Yet, all the time that he was growing up, he longed to have them around him. The loneliness of his two aunts in the family household was a daily reminder to him of the price of being a revolutionary and eventually led him to eschew marriage for himself. He did not want his wife to be subjected to the same tribulations. In the circumstances, he developed a burning hatred for the British. [1] It is not difficult to understand how, as the veteran writer, Malwinder Jit Singh Warraich states that the 'obsession of Bhagat Singh with his *Chacha* [uncle] never left him'. [2] Ajit Singh had it particularly hard, when as a peasant organizer, who had founded the Bharat Mata Society, he spent most of his life in exile. For Bhagat Singh, this was on top of having to see his father, Kishan Singh, a Congress worker, not being spared time on scores of occasions. Unsurprisingly, Bhagat Singh too found himself falling under British surveillance from a young age. He was barely out of his teenage years when the police labelled him a 'well-known suspect'. But by then Bhagat Singh was not only immersed in his own activities with the Punjabi youth organization Naujawan Bharat Sabha, but further afield had also established connections with the HRA in Kanpur.

As early as 1926, the Criminal Intelligence Department (CID) was able give a tolerably clear description of him as being 'of medium height; thin oval face; fair complexion; slightly pock-pitted; aquiline nose; bright eyes; small beard and moustache; wears Khaddar'. [3] By 1927, he was being unnecessarily subjected to police harassment. This is when he was